

Over 10 million airport passengers?

Testing Malta International Airport's 2025 traffic figure against Eurostat

THE CLAIM UNDER REVIEW

“...full-year traffic for 2025 up to 10,061,969 passenger movements, marking a 12.3% increase over the previous year.”

Malta International Airport plc, company announcement 461/2026, 14 January 2026.

Full-year traffic update to the Malta Stock Exchange.

VERDICT: SUPPORTED

Eurostat: 10,070,972 passengers in 2025, +12.3%

Version 1.0 · 5 October 2026

Status: no right of reply needed

Prepared from public sources and Eurostat data.

Repository: github.com/leandergrech/Mizien

MIZIEN · AN INDEPENDENT FACT-CHECKING PROJECT

Contest a verdict, with evidence: github.com/leandergrech/Mizien/issues

TL;DR

In a company announcement to the Malta Stock Exchange on 14 January 2026, Malta International Airport plc said that December traffic “**brought full-year traffic for 2025 up to 10,061,969 passenger movements, marking a 12.3% increase over the previous year.**” We checked the figure against Eurostat’s airport statistics.

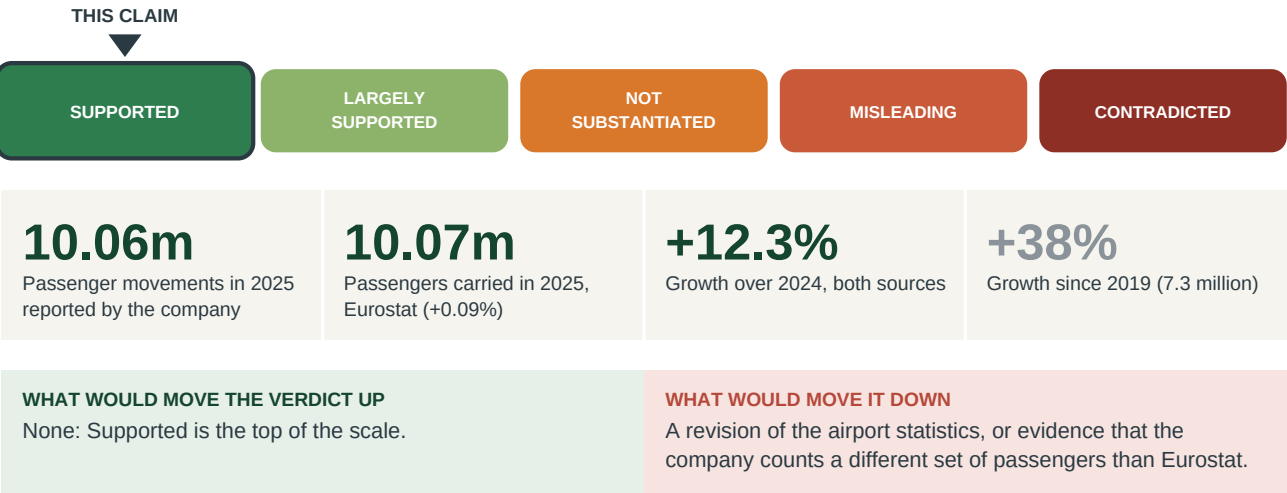
- 1

The figure is right. Eurostat records 10,070,972 passengers carried through Malta’s airport in 2025, 0.09% more than the company’s figure, and 8,968,239 in 2024: an increase of 12.3%, as stated.
- 2

2025 was the first year above 10 million. Traffic was 7.3 million in 2019 and 7.8 million in 2023; it has grown 38% since 2019.
- 3

“Passenger movements” are not travellers. Each arrival and each departure is counted, so a visitor or resident on a return trip counts twice. The company’s public pages sometimes say “passengers” for the same number; its stock-exchange text says “passenger movements”, which is accurate.
- 4

Verdict: supported (high confidence). The company’s figure and growth rate are confirmed by independent statistics.



IN THIS REPORT	
1 The claim and what we could verify	5 Testing the claim
2 Method	6 Verdict and requests for evidence
3 What the data show	7 Limitations
4 What the figure does not say	

1 The claim and what we could verify

The claim record came from the company’s “Facts and Figures” page, which on 5 October 2026 still said the airport was “eyeing 9.3 million passenger movements by the end of 2025”, an outdated forecast. The company’s statement of the outcome is its full-year traffic update, company announcement 461/2026 of 14 January 2026 [1], read in full. Lovin Malta reported a Facebook post by the company on 30 December 2025 saying it had handled “a record 10 million passengers” [2].

Source	What it says	Our access	Status
Malta International Airport plc, company announcement 461/2026, 14 Jan 2026 [1]	“This figure brought full-year traffic for 2025 up to 10,061,969 passenger movements, marking a 12.3% increase over the previous year.”	Full PDF read, 5 Oct 2026.	The claim
Eurostat, avia_paoc [3]	Passengers carried at Malta’s airport by year, schedule and destination.	Downloaded 5 Oct 2026 (data/cc-100/).	Primary data

2 Method

Question. Did Malta’s airport handle more than 10 million passenger movements in 2025, and did traffic grow by 12.3%?

Evidence. We downloaded Eurostat’s air passenger transport for Malta (avia_paoc, updated 2 October 2026), 2015–2025 (*tools/cc-100-report/fetch.py*), recorded the company’s figures from its announcement (*data/cc-100/mia_announcements.csv*) and compared them (*calc.py*; outputs in *data/cc-100/checks.csv*). Eurostat’s “passengers carried” counts arriving and departing passengers at the reporting airport, the same concept as the company’s “passenger movements”. Malta has one airport, so the national figure is the airport’s.

Grades. Official statistics, grade C; the company’s figure is its own report. No literature is needed. **Verdicts** follow the five-point scale in Appendix A.

3 What the data show

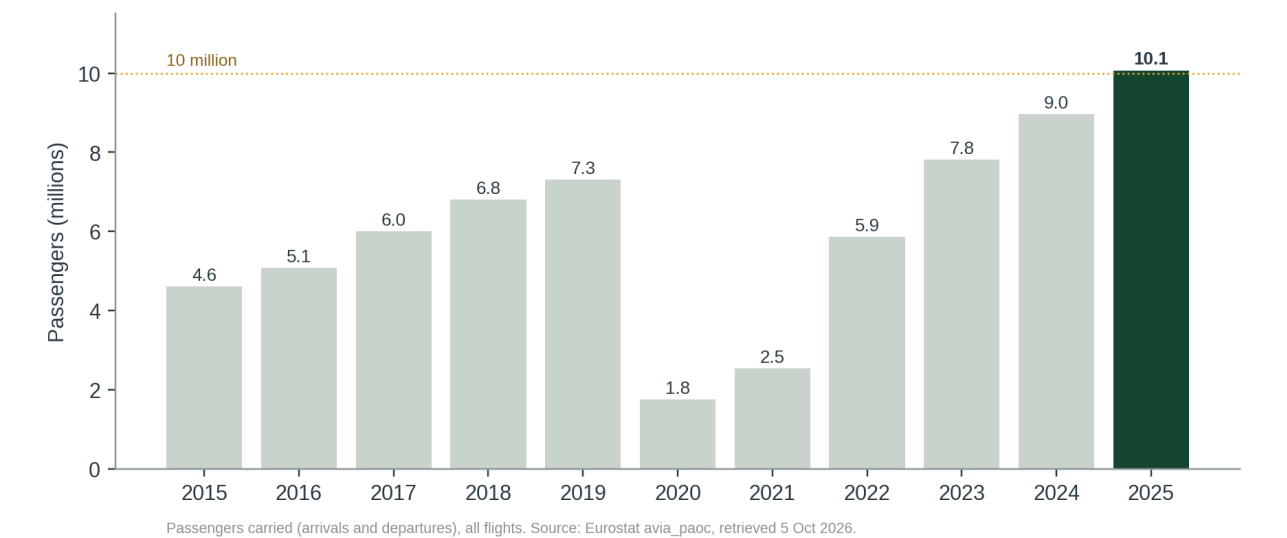


Figure 1. Passengers carried through Malta’s airport, 2015–2025 (Eurostat).

Traffic passed 10 million for the first time in 2025. Eurostat’s total exceeds the company’s by 9,003 passengers (0.09%), a difference of the kind expected between an operator’s count and the statistical return. 29% of 2025 passengers flew to or from airports outside the EU.

4 What the figure does not say

The claim is about traffic, not about its effects. Ten million movements are roughly five million return journeys by visitors and residents. Growth in air traffic bears on other claims in this project: the airport’s carbon-neutrality claim (CC-030), the growth of tourism (CC-083 to CC-085) and the pressure of visitor numbers on infrastructure (CC-089). This check does not assess any of those.

5 Testing the claim

Sub-claim	Said by	What the evidence shows	Rating
A. Full-year traffic for 2025 of 10,061,969 passenger movements	MIA plc [1]	Eurostat: 10,070,972 passengers carried in 2025 (+0.09%). First year above 10 million.	ACCURATE
B. A 12.3% increase over the previous year	MIA plc [1]	Eurostat: 8,968,239 in 2024 to 10,070,972 in 2025, +12.3%.	ACCURATE

6 Verdict and requests for evidence

VERDICT

SUPPORTED

Independent statistics confirm the total and the growth rate. Confidence: high.

Why. Both numbers reproduce from Eurostat within a tenth of a percent. **What this verdict does not say.** It does not say whether the growth is good or sustainable; it confirms a count.

Evidence we are asking for

- ☐ From the company: an update of its Facts and Figures page, which still shows the 2025 forecast of 9.3 million.

RIGHT OF REPLY

Not needed for this verdict (maintainer rule of 5 October 2026).

7 Limitations

- Eurostat’s and the company’s counts can differ slightly in their treatment of transit and transfer passengers; the difference here is 0.09%.
- We did not read the company’s Facebook post itself, only Lovin Malta’s report of it.

References

- [1] Malta International Airport plc (14 Jan 2026). Full-Year Traffic Update. Company announcement 461/2026.
<https://maltairport.com/app/uploads/2026/01/Full-Year-Traffic-Update.pdf>
- [2] Lovin Malta (30 Dec 2025). Malta International Airport Records Milestone Year With 10 Million Passengers.
<https://lovinmalta.com/malta/malta-international-airport-records-milestone-year-with-10-million-passengers/>
- [3] Eurostat. Air passenger transport by type of schedule, transport coverage and country (avia_paoc), updated 2 Oct 2026, retrieved 5 Oct 2026. https://ec.europa.eu/eurostat/databrowser/view/avia_paoc/default/table
- [4] MiŻien. Calculation script and outputs: tools/cc-100-report/calc.py; data/cc-100/checks.csv.

Appendix A: series standards and verdict scale

Every investigation in this series follows the same rules so that verdicts are comparable and challengeable.

Verdict	Meaning
SUPPORTED	Evidence consistently backs the claim as stated.
LARGELY SUPPORTED	Backed by the evidence, with minor caveats that do not change the substance.
NOT SUBSTANTIATED	Stated more strongly than the evidence offered or available allows. May be true in some conditions but has not been shown.
MISLEADING	Omits material facts so that the overall impression is inaccurate, even if individual statements are defensible.
CONTRADICTED	The available evidence points against the claim.

Confidence

High: multiple independent lines of evidence agree. **Moderate:** evidence is relevant but incomplete or indirect. **Low:** evidence is thin, second-hand or conflicting.

Evidence grades

A experiment · B observational study with a control or gradient · C review, guidance or official statistics · D assertion or anecdote. ♦ marks a source known only second-hand.

Standards

- **Quote the speaker, not the headline**, with outlet and date, and link the original where possible.
- **Separate the claim from the evidence offered for it**, and say who made which statement.
- **Grade the evidence** and show differing views side by side where the evidence is unsettled.
- **State what we could not access or verify**, and what would change the verdict either way.
- **Ask for the missing evidence** in specific, answerable requests.
- **Offer a right of reply** where a check finds a claim Not substantiated, Misleading or Contradicted (or a pledge Not measurable, Off track or Missed), before wider circulation, and append responses.
- **Correct errors openly** with a version number and change log.
- **Whistle-blow only on evidence:** a verdict of *Misleading* or *Contradicted* requires documents or data that can be shown, not inference.
- **Check every side.** Government, opposition, NGOs and developers are held to the same standard.

Appendix B: revision log

Version	Date	Change
1.0	5 Oct 2026	First issue. Verdict Supported (high confidence); no right of reply needed.